



SNOWBE ONLINE Policy# PWS-04

Password Standard

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Password Standard – Version 2.0

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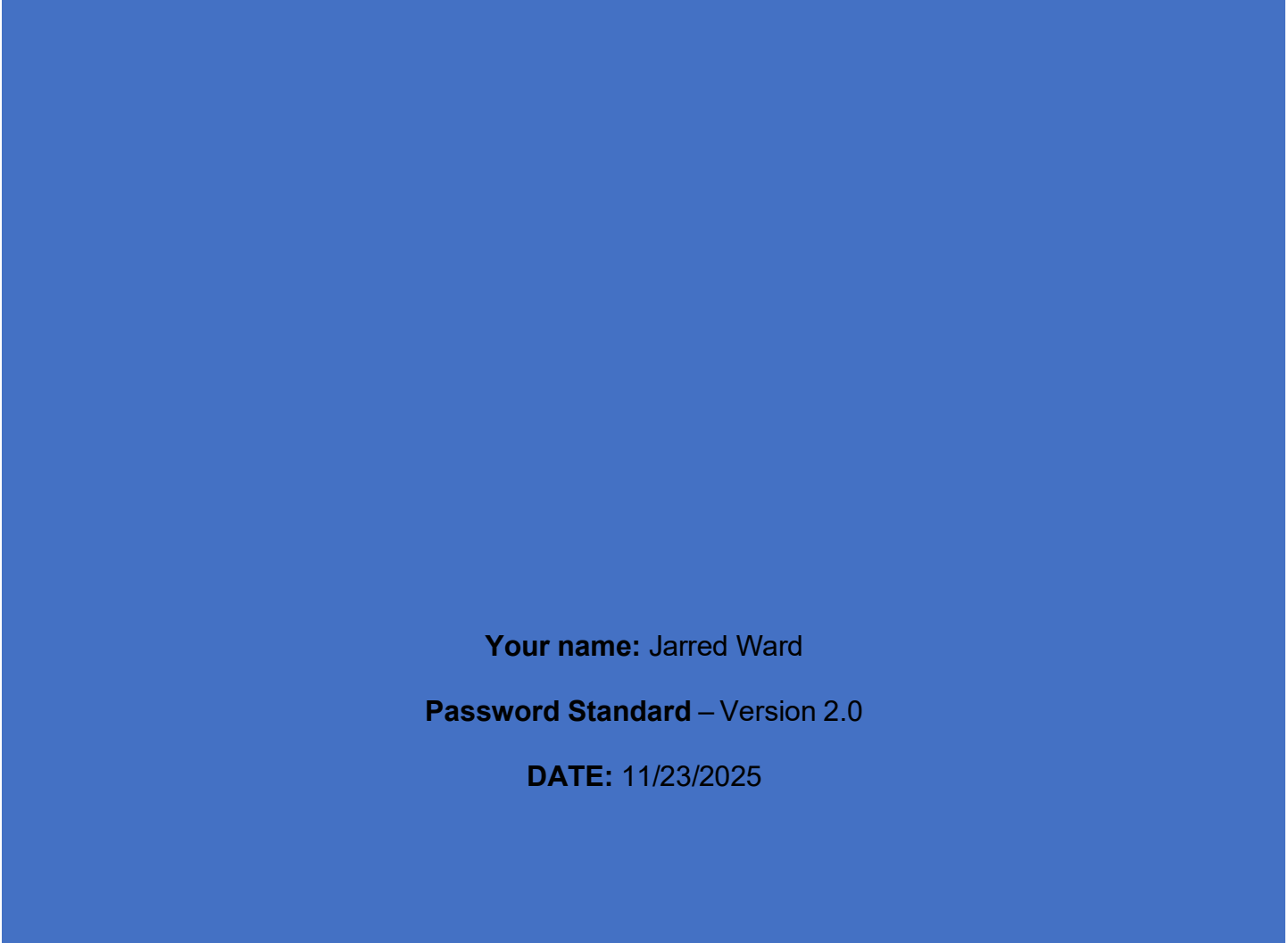


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Purpose

This standard establishes the required rules for creating and managing passwords across all SnowBe systems, accounts, and cloud environments. It ensures consistent protection of SnowBe's customer data, internal resources, and AWS-hosted services by requiring strong and secure password practices. The standard exists to provide a clear and enforceable baseline for password-based security throughout the organization.

Scope

This standard applies to all SnowBe employees, contractors, vendors, interns, and third parties who use password authentication to access SnowBe systems. It covers all SnowBe-managed applications, AWS services, endpoints, administrative environments, and point-of-sale systems. Any system integrated with SnowBe's identity and access management environment must comply with the requirements in this standard.

Definitions

Account Lockout Threshold

The number of failed login attempts allowed before a system temporarily blocks access to prevent unauthorized entry.

Brute Force Attack

A method where attackers attempt many password combinations until the correct one is discovered.

Credential Reuse

The practice of using the same password across multiple accounts or systems.

Hashing

A cryptographic process that converts passwords into unreadable values for secure storage.

Privileged Account

An account with elevated permissions that allow administrative or system-level control.

Roles & Responsibilities

CISO

The CISO oversees SnowBe's enterprise security strategy and ensures authentication and identity processes meet organizational and regulatory requirements.

Help Desk

Assists users with account-related issues, including access troubleshooting and identity verification. They support secure authentication by helping with password resets and MFA assistance.

Security Analyst

Monitors for authentication activity, enforces security controls, and investigates access anomalies. They maintain password security protections across SnowBe environments.

IT Administrator

Configures and maintains SnowBe's infrastructure, cloud services, and identity management platforms to ensure reliable and secure access. They enforce password settings, lockout thresholds, and authentication mechanisms across all SnowBe systems.

User

Users must protect their credentials, follow authentication requirements, and securely manage passwords to maintain the integrity of SnowBe systems and data.

Standard

SnowBe Online requires account passwords to comply with password standard requirements to help protect the integrity of resources and data. All current and new accounts are subject to the following password requirements.

1. Password Complexity Requirements

Strong passwords are required to prevent unauthorized access to SnowBe systems, AWS resources, retail operations, and administrative tools. The following complexity rules ensure that all SnowBe passwords meet a uniform security baseline.

- Minimum 12 characters for standard user accounts.
- Minimum 16 characters for privileged or administrative accounts.
- Must include uppercase characters (e.g., A-Z)
- Must include lowercase characters (e.g., a-z).
- Must include numbers (e.g., 0-9).
- Must include special characters (e.g., !@#\$%^&*()_+|~-='\"{ }[]:;,<>?,./).
- Must not include dictionary words, personal information, SnowBe product names, customer names, or retail location numbers.
- Must not include predictable character sequences (e.g., "abcd1234" or "Password2025").
- Passphrases of 16+ characters are strongly recommended for all account types.

2. Password Storage Requirements

Proper password storage ensures that credentials remain protected from disclosure, interception, or misuse. These requirements define the approved methods for securely storing credentials across all SnowBe platforms.

- Passwords must be stored only in the SnowBe-approved encrypted password manager.
- Passwords may not be stored in browsers, plaintext files, email, or physical notes.
- Systems must hash and salt all passwords using SnowBe-approved algorithms.
- Service account credentials must be stored in the SnowBe credential vault.

3. Password Transmission Requirements

Passwords must be protected anytime they are delivered, exchanged, or transmitted between people, devices, or systems. These requirements ensure credentials are never exposed over insecure channels.

- Passwords must never be transmitted through email, SMS, or unencrypted channels.
- Temporary passwords must be delivered only through SnowBe's secure credential delivery method.
- Passwords must not be spoken aloud in public or visible during screen sharing.

4. Device-Specific Requirements

Different SnowBe devices require tailored password protections to account for operational, environmental, and compliance needs. The following subsections specify the required authentication standards for each device category.

4.1 Workstations & Laptops

- Login must be required at startup, wake, or unlock.
- Automatic screen lock must activate after 10 minutes of inactivity.
- Authentication must integrate with SnowBe's identity provider.

4.2 Retail Point-of-Sale (POS) Systems

- Retail staff must use unique credentials or PINs.
- Shared POS passwords are prohibited.
- POS administrator credentials must follow privileged password requirements.

4.3 Mobile Devices (Corporate & BYOD)

- Devices must use at least a 6-digit passcode or secure biometric.
- Devices must lock after 5 minutes of inactivity.
- Biometric unlock does not replace system password requirements.

4.4 Service Accounts

- Must use system-generated passwords of 24+ characters.
- Credentials must be stored in the SnowBe credential vault.
- Must not allow interactive logins.

5. Password Lifecycle Requirements

Routine password changes help reduce the risk of compromised credentials being used for extended periods. These requirements define the frequency and conditions under which SnowBe passwords must be updated.

- Standard passwords must be changed every 180 days.
- Privileged passwords must be changed every 90 days.
- Passwords must be changed immediately when compromise is suspected.
- Users may not reuse any of the previous 10 passwords.

6. Account Lockout Requirements

Account lockouts protect SnowBe systems from repeated unauthorized login attempts and automated brute-force attacks. These requirements define the behavior that authentication systems must enforce during failed login attempts.

- Accounts must lock after 5 failed login attempts.
- Lockouts must last at least 10 minutes or require identity verification.
- Failed login attempts must be logged and reviewed by a Security Analyst.

7. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) Requirements

MFA adds a second layer of security and is required for systems housing sensitive or privileged access functions. These requirements ensure all high-risk SnowBe systems adopt stronger authentication protections.

- Required for AWS, HR, Finance, VPN, POS administration, and production environments.
- Required for systems containing PCI, PII, PHI, or SnowBe confidential information.
- Approved MFA includes hardware tokens, app-based authenticators, and FIDO2 keys.

8. Reporting Requirements

Prompt reporting is essential for reducing risk when unauthorized access attempts or suspicious login behaviors occur. These requirements ensure users act quickly to notify SnowBe Security.

- Users must report suspicious MFA prompts, unknown login attempts, or unexpected password reset messages.
- Security Analysts will investigate and may require password resets or MFA re-registration.

Exceptions/Exemptions

Requests for exceptions must be submitted in writing to SnowBe Online's IT Security Manager for review and approval. Each request must include the business justification, defined scope, duration, and any compensating controls that will be applied. All approved exceptions will be formally documented, reviewed periodically for continued appropriateness, and remain valid for no longer than one year unless re-evaluated and re-approved.

Enforcement

Failure to follow this policy may result in disciplinary action, beginning with a verbal warning and escalating to written notice, suspension of system access, or termination of employment. Contractors and vendors who violate SnowBe Online's security or compliance requirements may have their access revoked or contracts terminated. Intentional or severe violations, especially those involving customer data or payment systems, may lead to termination and potential legal or regulatory action under applicable laws.

Version History Table

Version #	Implementation Date	Document Owner	Approved By	Description
1.0	10/29/2025	Jarred Ward	IT Security Manager	Original Draft
2.0	11/23/2025	Jarred Ward	IT Security Manager	Updated Password Standard

Citations

Michigan Technological University - <https://www.mtu.edu/it/security/policies-procedures-guidelines/password-standards.pdf> (Used for Scope).

State of Arkansas - https://sas.arkansas.gov/wp-content/uploads/2020/04/SS-70-002_password_standard.pdf (Used for Definitions).

State of Oklahoma - <https://oklahoma.gov/content/dam/ok/en/omes/documents/PasswordRequirementsStd.pdf> (Used for Purpose).

University of Central Florida - <https://infosec.ucf.edu/document/501-password-standards/> (Used for Enforcement).

United States Department of Education - <https://www.ed.gov/sites/ed/files/fund/contract/about/acs/2021-password-parameters.pdf> (Used for Exceptions/Exemptions).

Weill Cornell Medicine - <https://its.weill.cornell.edu/policies/1115-password-policy> (Used for Standard, Roles & Responsibilities).